

users don't need more than 4 GB, gamers don't need more than 8 GB. 3D designers and programmers who deal with memory intensive programs need as much memory as possible.

What to buy

When thinking of choosing which RAM to get, remember the following:

1. More is always better though very few people need to populate all the RAM slots in a motherboard.
2. Purchase memory kits together i.e. same manufacturer and same batch. Since manufacturers mix up various brand of memory chips between batches there is a chance that the two RAM kits purchased a few months apart might give rise to compatibility problems.
3. RAM can be overclocked as well and certain SKUs scale better than others, reading a few reviews should tell you which particular SKU currently scales best. This way you can purchase a standard 1600 MHz module and overclock it to 2133 MHz.
4. Check your motherboard manual for a list of reliable vendors whose modules have been tested on your motherboard. Following this list ensures that you should have next to no problems getting your memory to work on the rated specification. Using modules which aren't included in the list would either work perfectly or it might scale down to the base speed supported by the processor.
5. If your motherboard does not support high speed memory then installing the same will lead to the memory kit being scaled down to whatever value the motherboard supports.
6. Voltage is also an important factor, current RAM modules use 1.25-1.5volts, stick to whatever is supported by your motherboard to be on the safer side.
7. The performance difference between a 1333 MHz RAM and a 1600 MHz RAM is quite huge, however, above 1600 MHz the performance increment per frequency increment reduces severely. 